

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 983

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to commend Representative Monty Fritts for his honorable and astute service to the people of Tennessee as a member of the House of Representatives.

WHEREAS, it is most appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those fellow legislators who have performed their duties with the utmost integrity and whose efforts during their time in office have been dedicated to providing thoughtful and exemplary service to their districts and to this great State; and

WHEREAS, Representative Monty Fritts of Kingston is one such distinguished public servant, who has served both his constituency and this legislative body with honor and ability; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure, Representative Fritts has been a highly influential figure in the political, social, and civic life of Roane and Loudon counties, and he has served his constituents in numerous capacities, always working diligently at his elected duties and expending the necessary effort to understand the opposing sides of complex issues; and

WHEREAS, Monty Fritts has distinguished himself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order and as an exceptional asset to the good people of the 32nd House District, whom he has served as a member of the 113th and 114th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, throughout his service, Monty Fritts has been prominent as a dedicated and well-informed legislator who always votes his conscience; and

WHEREAS, Representative Fritts earned his Bachelor of Science and Master of Arts degrees from Liberty University and holds a Master of Business Administration degree from the University of Tennessee; he also completed a certificate program in Leading Operations Excellence through the Massachusetts Institute of Technology; and

WHEREAS, although he is now a realtor, Monty Fritts spent most of his career in nuclear manufacturing; and

WHEREAS, starting as an hourly employee, he progressed into management and held positions as an Operations Manager in foreign nuclear non-proliferation efforts, Director-Manager of Enriched Uranium Operations, Program Liaison to NNSA, and University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Leadership Development Liaison at the Y-12 National Security Complex; and

WHEREAS, he also served as Director of Operations at Nuclear Fuel Services in Erwin, held a position at the U.S. Department of Energy, and was a Vice-President of Business Development; and

WHEREAS, he received letters of appreciation from U.S. Secretary of Defense Gates and U.S. Secretary of Energy Bodman in recognition of his many contributions; and

WHEREAS, a proud veteran, Representative Fritts initially served his country in the U.S. Army from 1983 until 1993; he then reenlisted in 2003 to support the 278 Armored Cavalry Regiment's deployment to Iraq; and

WHEREAS, during his exemplary military career, he earned the Army Combat Action Badge, two Army Commendations, the Good Conduct Medal, several campaign medals while serving in a combat zone, two Overseas Deployment Bars, the Army Achievement RC, NCO Professional Development ribbons, and combat service patches with the 1st Infantry Division, the 42nd Infantry Division, and the 278 Regimental Combat Team; and

WHEREAS, an active and dynamic participant in the legislative process during his time in the General Assembly, Representative Monty Fritts has rendered sterling service as Co-Chair of the Veterans Caucus, Vice-Chair of the Naming and Designating Committee, and Vice-Chair of the Joint Government Operations Education, Health and General Welfare Subcommittee; and

WHEREAS, he has also served with distinction as a member of the Agriculture and Natural Resources Committee, Government Operations Committee, Agriculture and Natural Resources Subcommittee, Joint Government Operations Commerce, Labor, Transportation and Agriculture Subcommittee, and the Joint Government Operations Judiciary and Government Subcommittee; and

WHEREAS, he further served on the Nuclear Legislative Working Group within the National Conference of State Legislatures, the Southern States Energy Board, and the Energy and Environment Committee of the Council of State Governments; and

WHEREAS, Monty Fritts has proven that citizens can make a difference by being involved in their community, which he has demonstrated as a life member of the VFW (Post 5150 Loudon), the American Legion (Post 50 Rockwood), the National Rifle Association, The Society of the First Infantry Division, and the Tennessee Firearms Association and a member of the Gun Owners of America and the National Association of Gun Rights; and

WHEREAS, he is an ardent supporter of the Life Choices Medical Center and the Parent Loss Scholarship Fund at Liberty University; and

WHEREAS, a member of First Baptist Church Rockwood, Representative Fritts is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his wife, Denise, their two sons and daughters-in-law, and their three grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, throughout his outstanding career as a public servant, Representative Fritts has worked tirelessly on behalf of his constituents, bringing to his office an honorable bearing and the traditional values of hard work and common sense; and

WHEREAS, Representative Monty Fritts is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized for his exemplary tenure in the General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor Representative Monty Fritts for his meritorious service to Tennessee as a member of the House of Representatives, commend him for his countless contributions and many good works in service of the citizens of the 32nd House District, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.